

Mental Health and Wellbeing

MENTAL HEALTH AND WELLBEING

What is Mental Health?

Mental health includes emotional, psychological, and social wellbeing. It's as important as physical health.

Common Mental Health Conditions:

Depression: Persistent sadness and loss of interest, affects daily functioning, more than just being sad, treatable with therapy and/or medication

Anxiety Disorders: Excessive worry and fear, physical symptoms like racing heart and sweating, can be generalized or specific

Risk Factors:

- Genetics/family history
- Brain chemistry
- Trauma or adverse events
- Chronic stress
- Substance abuse
- Medical conditions
- Social isolation

Support and Treatment:

Therapy Options:

- Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT)
- Psychotherapy
- Group therapy
- Family therapy

Medications:

- Antidepressants
- Anti-anxiety medications
- Mood stabilizers
- Antipsychotics

Self-Care Strategies:

- Regular exercise
- Healthy sleep schedule
- Balanced diet
- Social connections
- Relaxation techniques (meditation, yoga)
- Limiting alcohol and drugs
- Spending time in nature
- Creative activities
- Setting boundaries

When to Seek Help:

- Persistent sadness or worry

- Loss of interest in activities
- Changes in sleep or appetite
- Difficulty concentrating
- Thoughts of self-harm

Remember: Seeking help is a sign of strength, not weakness. Recovery is possible.